Manaka Yamakawa

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley - Haas Spieker Program **Class of 2029**
B.S. Business Administration & B.A. Data Science

Gems American Academy, Abu Dhabi **Class of 2025**
Valedictorian/Student Council Vice President - Summa Cum Laude *(GPA 4.35/4.00)*

WORK EXPERIENCE

HM GROUP Remote
Academic tutor June 2025 – present
・Tutored for 10+ students in IB Econ, Math AA, Chem, and Business, qualifying for the highest tuition rate.
・Selected as a top tutor after passing four screening tests, qualifying for the highest tuition rate.

KPMG JAPAN Tokyo, Japan
Special Intern August 2025
・Selected as the youngest of 25 summer 1-day interns, analyzing Japanese companies' approaches to M&A.
・Secured an exception to participate (program limited to Classes of 2026–2028) by directly engaging with HR.
・Arranged follow-up meetings with the HR manager during the UC Berkeley recruitment visit (Oct 19–20).

MIBU Co., Ltd. Tokyo, Japan
Co-founder/Director April 2022 – August 2025
・Won 1st place in a pitch competition, earning ¥1,000,000 (~$7,000) in startup funding.
・Designed an app to promote entrepreneurship through internship opportunities and fundraising support.
・Led a team of 50+ members, guiding over 90% to DECA business plan competition finalist status.
・Spoke at SIW Shibuya 2023 (167,000 attendees); led marketing for 31K+ subscriber YouTube channel.

Chie Kimono Abu Dhabi Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates
Founder/Organizer January 2024 – June 2025
・Founded a kimono rental service with private lessons for Emirati, earning 1,500 AED (~$400) monthly.
・Collaborated with Mandarin Oriental Hotel in showcasing Japanese culture for embassy functions.

Kyoto University, Graduate School of Asian and African Area Studies Kyoto, Japan
Student researcher July 2023 – December 2024
・Conducted research on Islamic microeconomics and capitalism under Prof. Shinsuke Nagaoka.
・Authored a paper on how EU sanctions on Russia affected Dubai's real estate market investment.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY IMPACT

The University of Tokyo Remote
News writer, Marketer June 2023 – December 2024
・Published monthly articles on politics/education/economics for NEWSDOCK, the university's largest media.
・Methodized an Instagram marketing strategy using Figma, driving follower growth of 200%+ in one year.

UmeJP (DECA JAPAN) Tokyo, Japan
Vice President April 2022 – December 2024
・Proposed entrepreneurship curriculum reforms to Japan's Ministry of Education, initiating digital economy discussion at the G7/G20 Hiroshima Youth Summit.
・Founded the largest online MUN in Japan/UAE, hosting 7 conferences for 830+ students from 85+ countries.

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

・JICA Essay Contest - awarded a fully funded 1-week study trip to the Philippines (2nd/37,592 applicants).
・John and Miyoko Davey Foundation Scholarship - awarded a US$120,000 merit-based scholarship.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Skills: Qualitative/Quantitative research, startups management, marketing **Languages**: English and Japanese

Interests: strategy consulting, overseas expansion, VC, banking, travel, sushi, fashion, soccer, swimming, F1